

Seniors United Now

The Voice of Seniors in Alberta

What's Happening at SUN Bulletin #3

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#37, 2016 Sherwood Dr.
Sherwood Park, AB
T8A 3X3
Phone: 780-449-1816
Toll Free 1-855-786-8669
Email: unitenow@telus.net
www.seniorsunitednow.com

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Dear Seniors United Now Members,

The UCP government announced on October 14th that they plan to cut 11,000 Alberta Health Service jobs and save \$600 million annually. This savings is being achieved by transferring jobs from public service pay grid to private companies pay grid. This loss of annual income will significantly reduce the purchasing power of 11,000 Albertans. This strategy could have significant impact on our economy during a pandemic.

On October 15th, the UCP government announced that they are going to launch budget consultations on further spending and saving priorities before the next provincial budget is released in February. These announcements mean that provincial spending cuts are coming and that seniors will most likely be affected. Our standard of living could be significantly lowered.

The Board of Directors have discussed this possibility at our October 2nd board meeting. We intend to make our voices heard through the consultation period and the survey that is being proposed. We would urge all SUN members to also respond to the survey and make our combined voices heard. We also plan to make our concerns known to the various ministers who are involved in seniors care and seniors' benefits.

The NDP party has also announced on October 15th That they will also be seeking input from Albertans on the province's economic future. Consultations will be conducted online and SUN will respond to this initiative. The board would urge our members to also respond.

The SUN board suggests that the governments plan to reduce deficits must also consider a plan to increase revenues. It must be a creative process that provides support to the economy to grow and thereby create more revenues. A one sided reduction in spending only, is not the answer. It would create the impression that the budget is being balanced on the backs of Albertans, many of whom, cannot afford any reduction in their standard of living. Albertans need a creative and fair plan. One we can all work together on.

If we are to work our way out of the current deficit spending, Albertans will need to stimulate the economy and return to a new normal. We need to hope for an economic recovery in year 2021.

Keep well and take care of each other.
Gordon Voth, President

